



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Paideia Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://paideiaclassicalchristian.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Paideia Classical Christian School (Oregon City, OR, 97045) presents a robust Christian, classical-leaning program that foregrounds character formation, liturgical-infused practice, and a classical curricular sensibility within a K–12 framework. Public materials from the school's site repeatedly emphasize Christ-centered learning, formation, and a paideia-based approach, with explicit references to worship, Scripture memory, and a governance/teacher-mentorship model. While the school clearly adopts classical language (e.g., "Classical Approach," Paideia framing, and a structured curriculum for memory, catechesis, and liturgy), explicit weekly evidence of core classical lexicon items like extensive Great Books exposure or explicit Socratic seminars across the full K–12 range is less visible in the public-facing materials provided here. Taken together, the school appears predominantly CLASSICAL with meaningful CLASSICAL-leaning attributes, but with room to more fully articulate and document classic elements such as extensive Great Books integration and explicit high-school Socratic pedagogy across curricula.

Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly foregrounded through explicit Christ-centered framing, Scripture memory, liturgical language, and paideia-driven aims. Evidence includes the school's Christ-centered framing, reference to the paideia of the Lord, and liturgical-style teaching emphasis.
- School Purpose and Goal centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological reading of education, with strong emphasis on Christian character formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real.
- Curriculum shows clear liberal-arts framing and a curriculum built around Scripture, memory work, and catechesis, with explicit elementary content that includes biblical text, catechisms, and historical study; however, explicit Great Books coverage is not strongly evidenced in the public materials examined.
- Pedagogy highlights contemplative/restful learning in lower grades and a call to worship through music, with explicit mentions of singing, memory, and a liturgical cadence, though explicit high-school Socratic seminars are not clearly documented in these public materials.
- Faculty materials visible in public content show named leadership and a staff-centric model, though a deeply articulated "living curriculum" or portrait of teacher formation is less explicit in the site text.
- Parents & Community emphasis is strong, with explicit framing of partnership with parents, parent formation, and open-campus/volunteer opportunities, aligning with classical-community partnership signals.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school positions itself as Christian with paideia-focused language and liturgical vitality in its rhetoric and programming, including direct references to “paideia of the Lord,” worship, and Christ-centered aims.
- Public materials discuss training worshipers of Jesus Christ and a Christ-centered mission, signaling transcendental ideals and moral formation rooted in theology. ☐filecite☐turn0file☐turn0file5☐

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: truth/virtue/worship/theology/scripture/paideia of the Lord/liturgical elements/worship music/creed. A direct Christ-centered framing and liturgical emphasis appear in multiple pages.
- Negative indicators: none observed in public materials.

Why this rating

- The public materials demonstrate a coherent religious-metaphysical program with explicit theology, liturgy-like practices (singing, worship), and a paideia framework—strong signals of a CLASSICAL orientation in the religious dimension. The absence of negative signals and the robust explicit Christianity content supports CLASSICAL here.

ABSTRACT

ed evidence anchors: Christ-centered language; paideia of the Lord; liturgical/music emphasis.

What would move the needle

- Increase explicit articulation of liturgical-year rhythms as a formal curricular strand and document theology-integrated inquiry across disciplines. Also consider foregrounding explicit liturgical/choral components as a “public-facing” standard in mission statements with examples from daily practice.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school frames education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, grounded in a Christian teleology and the paideia concept. The mission emphasizes enculturation in the Lord's paideia and training toward virtue and human excellence.
- The rhetoric points to formation over mere information, and to the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ideals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, human flourishing (as implied by formation and virtue emphasis), classical mission.
- Negative indicators: none explicit in public materials.

Why this rating

- The public voice emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical mission, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for this category. The absence of job-prep language and the explicit, ongoing focus on formation and virtue push toward CLASSICAL rather than Not Classical.

What would move the needle

- Explicitly quantify and surface the telos (human excellence) in a short, public-facing mission commitment; add explicit statements on how truth, goodness, and beauty are pursued across disciplines (e.g., a glossary or page outlining how Great Books/Great Conversation anchors formation).

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Elementary curriculum section highlights Scripture memory, catechesis, Bible study, and moral formation (e.g., Old Testament stories, New City Catechism, memorized Scripture). This aligns with a classical-formatting approach, but the explicit articulation of classic liberal arts strands (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and exposure to Great Books at scale is not clearly documented in the public-facing materials provided.
- Public materials emphasize a “Classical Approach” and K–12 structure, but do not consistently demonstrate explicit Great Books exposure or the full triad of liberal arts in documented text. The “Elementary Curriculum” shows Bible-based content and memory work rather than a full Great Books-focused program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: liberal-arts framing implied by “Classical Approach” and a memory/recitation emphasis; curriculum includes Bible-based content and moral formation.
- Negative indicators: limited explicit references to Great Books, triad of grammar-logic-rhetoric, or explicit Great Conversation in the public text. Social studies/historic framing appears through Bible-history content rather than standard liberal-arts history framing.

Why this rating

- The curriculum shows classical components (memory, catechesis, sacred literature) but lacks strong, explicit evidence of core liberal-arts sequencing (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and explicit Great Books/-Great Conversation integration as surfaced in the public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

What would move the needle

- Explicitly publish and foreground a Great Books/Great Conversation plan for upper grades and clearly map grammar-logic-rhetoric progression across grades. Include explicit summaries of Western history and philosophy strands within the curriculum (not only Bible-history material) to demonstrate full liberal-arts coverage.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public content emphasizes contemplative/restful learning and scholé-like approaches (e.g., “singing and memory,” lower-school teaching culture, and contemplative ambiance). The “How We Teach” piece highlights singing and melody as central, with an aim to train worshipers of Jesus Christ, indicating a pedagogy that integrates memory, chant, and liturgical rhythm.
- There are explicit lower-school practices (singing, memory work) and upper-school opportunities for rhetoric and oratory in the classical tradition, though explicit high-school Socratic seminars are not clearly demonstrated in the public text.
- The presence of a “Classical Approach” label and K–12 structure signals alignment with classical pedagogy in general, though some core elements (e.g., explicit collegiate-level Socratic seminars across grades) are not overtly documented in the accessible materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: contemplative/scholé/restful learning; memory work; singing/chanting; memory-focused pedagogy; references to rhetoric and public speaking in the context of upper grades.

- Negative indicators: limited explicit documentation of full Socratic seminars or project-based/experiential-only pedagogy; no strong evidence of constructivist approaches in the public text.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy shows clear classical-oriented signals (memory, chant, liturgical integration, rhetoric in upper grades) but lacks comprehensive public evidence of the full Socratic seminar culture across high school and explicit non-memorial, non-chant-based inquiry across all grades. This supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Publish a formal Pedagogy Overview detailing: (a) frequency and scope of Socratic seminars in upper grades, (b) explicit use of memory work and dictation in core subjects beyond Bible/memory routines, (c) a documented plan for integrating scholé/restful learning across the curriculum, and (d) a clear articulation of how student-led inquiry and experiments are integrated with classical pedagogy rather than replacing it.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials identify specific leadership roles (Head of School, Director of Academics and Admissions, faculty pages) and provide bios for the leadership team, indicating a defined faculty structure.
- The site communicates a sense of faculty as mentors and leaders, with a strong focus on academics and administration, but explicit language about “living curriculum,” mentor-mentee models, or a formal portrait of teacher ideals is not consistently visible in the public text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: named leaders and a formal administrative structure; emphasis on academics and Teacher/Staff roles.
- Negative indicators: no explicit, repeated statements of a “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” or a formal teacher-professional-development framework in the public pages observed.

Why this rating

- There is clear leadership and a defined staff/academic structure, which supports classical school organization; however, the depth of the living-curriculum/teacher-formation signals is not strongly evidenced in public text. This warrants SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Add public-facing statements and materials detailing a teacher-formation program (model teachers/mentors), a formal “living curriculum” narrative, and a teacher-portrait framework with concrete examples of mentorship and collegiality in practice.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with parents, parent formation (reading groups/seminars), and open-campus visits, aligning with classical-community expectations. The site references parent-participation structures and community events as part of its model.
- Public material also shows leadership and governance engagement with parents (e.g., Head of School/Director roles and family engagement in admissions).
- The public materials present the parents as co-educators in the paideia framework (e.g., emphasis on paideia in the home and school partnership).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis



- Positive indicators present: partnership with parents, parent formation, home-pulse/parent participation, open campus/visits, volunteer opportunities.
- Negative indicators: none evident in the public text; no explicit consumer/customer framing that would contradict classical partnership signals.

Why this rating

- Strong explicit signals of parental partnership and formation are evident, supporting CLASSICAL in this category.

What would move the needle

- Publicly publish a concise “Parents as Co-Teachers” charter with concrete programs (book clubs, study guides, family-liturgy alignment resources, and scheduled parent-education sessions) to reinforce and document the partnership more visibly.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Overall Impression

- Paideia Classical Christian School (Oregon City, OR, 97045) demonstrates solid classical-chartered orientation with substantial religious-theological grounding and a clearly stated formation goal. It shows strong catechetical and liturgical pedagogy and a public-facing claim to classical curriculum/methods, especially in religious formation and parental partnership. Nevertheless, explicit, comprehensive documentation of core classical elements—especially sustained Great Books exposure, explicit triad of grammar/logic/rhetoric in the curriculum across all grades, and a full culture of Socratic pedagogy in high school—are not strongly evidenced in the publicly accessible materials. The synthesis supports a ranking of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Publish explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments across grade bands and document a clear sequence of grammar-logic-rhetoric progression in the curriculum.
- Publicly articulate a broader, formalized Socratic/seminar culture across upper grades, with sample seminars and outcomes.
- Strengthen the teacher-formation narrative with a formal “living curriculum” model and tangible teacher-professor mentorship/reciprocal-learning practices publicly described.
- Expand the curricular emphasis on Western Intellectual Traditions (philosophy/history) alongside Scripture-focused content to deepen liberal-arts integration.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.